

MAKE A DIFFERENCE FUND

Tsunami 2004

Safe **KEEPING**

Warehouses built by CARE TODAY provide an all-weather storage option for tsunami-affected villages in Tamil Nadu



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**THE NEWLY BUILT
WAREHOUSE AT
PRATAPARAMAPURAM,
NAGAPATTINAM**

Following the tsunami that struck the southern coast of India on December 26, 2004, CARE TODAY joined hands with the Development of Humane Action (DHAN) Foundation, a non-governmental organisation, to construct three warehouses for tsunami-affected farmers living in Nagapattinam, Tamil Nadu. These warehouses at Kovilpathu, Prataparamapuram and Thandavanajkulam will benefit 1,290 tsunami-affected families. While the warehouse constructed at Kovilpathu has been in use since July, those at Prataparamapuram and Thandavanajkulam were inaugurated on November 16 at a simple community affair in the presence of senior officials of key financial and agriculture institutions working in these villages. The officials appreciated the infrastructure developed under this project by CARE TODAY and the DHAN Foundation and promised all possible support from their institutions to the farmers.

Each of the warehouses, measuring 20m x 10m, will benefit the farmers in many ways. They will not only provide them with storage facility for inputs such as seeds, fertilisers and farming tools, but also a

safe option for keeping their harvested produce. These storage spaces are being managed by the farmer's federations established by the DHAN Foundation as part of their on-going development activities in the region.

CARE TODAY had allocated Rs 35,18,250 for the construction of these warehouses. The DHAN Foundation, which had been working closely with the tsunami-affected communities, was able to complete the construction of these three warehouses and saved Rs 20,204, thanks to good planning and community support. After the completion of the three warehouses, CARE TODAY is planning to provide a grant of the remaining amount, about Rs 10.5 lakh, from the Make a Difference Tsunami Fund to the DHAN Foundation to build a similar facility for the fishing community in Cuddalore district.

CARE TODAY was set-up by the India Today Group in 1999 to channelise the contributions from readers to help victims of calamities. Various projects undertaken by it in the past 10 years have done their bit in rekindling hope in the lives of those who have otherwise been dealt a debilitating blow by nature.